

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 606

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Henry "Hank" Frederick Bertelkamp, Jr., of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Henry "Hank" Frederick Bertelkamp, Jr., of Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, Hank Bertelkamp was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on October 5, 1931, in Louisville, Kentucky, Mr. Bertelkamp was the son of Henry Frederick Bertelkamp, Sr., and Elizabeth Bosler Bertelkamp; and

WHEREAS, Hank Bertelkamp spent his formative years in Louisville and attended DuPont Manual High School, where he earned a reputation as a standout basketball player and graduated in 1949; and

WHEREAS, upon graduating from high school, Mr. Bertelkamp accepted a basketball scholarship to the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, where he played forward for the Volunteers from 1950 to 1953 and from which he graduated with a degree in business administration in 1953; and

WHEREAS, during his time with the Volunteers, Hank Bertelkamp was voted Most Valuable Player by his teammates, selected to compete in the East vs. West college all-star game, and named team captain as a senior in 1952; he finished his basketball career as a three-time letter winner; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bertelkamp averaged 8.9 points per game during his basketball career at the University of Tennessee and produced 14.3 points and 7.5 rebounds per game during his senior year; in honor of his impressive basketball career, Hank Bertelkamp was inducted into the Knoxville Sports Hall of Fame in 2001; and

WHEREAS, after he graduated from college, Mr. Bertelkamp was commissioned as a Second Lieutenant in the United States Army, during which tenure, he served for two years at Fort Bragg, North Carolina, and fifteen months in Pusan, Korea; and

WHEREAS, having completed his military service, Hank Bertelkamp worked as a successful sales engineer for Bellows Valvair for a number of years, before, in 1975, founding Bertelkamp Fluid Power, Inc., which was later renamed Bertelkamp Automation, Inc., (BAI) in 1985 and which celebrated its fiftieth anniversary in May 2025; and

WHEREAS, under Mr. Bertelkamp's leadership, BAI grew into a major factory automation firm in the Southeast that was rooted in honesty, integrity, and a family atmosphere, as proven by the company's low employee turnover rate; and

WHEREAS, Hank Bertelkamp was not only admired for his strong business acumen, but he was also greatly respected as a community leader, who gave his time, talents, and resources to many organizations, including the Helen Ross McNabb Center, Thrive, InterFaith Health Center, Knox Youth Sports, and United Way; and

WHEREAS, he held many leadership roles throughout his lifetime, including serving as chairman of the Greater Knoxville Chamber of Commerce, president of Cherokee Country Club, and as a board member for the University of Tennessee Athletic Department; and

WHEREAS, in August 2004, Hank Bertelkamp established the Bertelkamp Basketball Scholarship Endowment Fund to help provide assistance to student athletes, and in 2011, Mr. Bertelkamp was honored for his community leadership and public service when the Men's Basketball offices at Food City Center were named in his honor; and

WHEREAS, a devout Christian and an active member of St. John's Episcopal Cathedral, where he served as Senior Warden for several terms, Hank Bertelkamp was a regular participant in the Saturday morning Bible study at Cherokee Country Club; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bertelkamp was deeply devoted to his faith and his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his loving wife of sixteen years, Sandy Bertelkamp; son, Henry Frederick "Bert" (Sheila) Bertelkamp III; daughter, Lori Bertelkamp (Tom) McKelvy; grandchildren, Wizzie (Dan) Irvin, Lan (Cara) Jones, Brownie Bertelkamp (James Michel, fiancé), Lillie (Grant) Bodie, and Hank Bertelkamp; great-grandchildren, Scotty Irvin, Sonny Irvin, London Jones, and Brooks Jones; stepchildren, John Fiser, David (Wendy) Fiser, and Caroline (John) Osborne; and step-grandchildren, Bo Fiser, Chase Fiser, Alli Dew, Sam Osborne, Jack Osborne, Kirby Osborne, and Luke Osborne; and a host of friends and church family; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Bertelkamp was preceded in death by his first wife, Jane Smith Bertelkamp; and son David Bertelkamp; and

WHEREAS, the epitome of excellence, Mr. Bertelkamp was a humble, patriotic, and faithful soul who impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know him, and he leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Henry "Hank" Frederick Bertelkamp, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Bertelkamp.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

